

CLAIM AMENDMENTS

This listing of claims will replace all prior versions and listings of claims in the application.

Listing of Claims

1-5) (Canceled)

6) (Previously presented) The method of claim 45, wherein said organic solvent is selected from the group consisting of ethyl acetate, methanol, and aqueous methanol.

7). (Previously presented) The method of claim 44, wherein said at least one symptom comprises obesity.

8) (Currently amended) The method of claim 44, wherein said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or *Ficus hispida* fruit is obtained by:

i) extracting *Ficus hispida* leaves with alcohol to produce a first extract, followed by sequentially:

ii) extracting said first extract with hexane to produce a second hexane extract and a first residue;

iii) optionally extracting said first residue with ethyl acetate to produce a third ethyl acetate extract and a second residue; and

iv) optionally extracting said second residue with alcohol to produce a fourth alcohol extract;

wherein said organic solvent extract is selected from the group consisting of said second hexane extract, said third ethyl acetate extract; and said fourth alcohol extract.

9) (Currently amended) The method of claim 8, wherein said second hexane extract, said third ethyl acetate extract, or said fourth methanol extract is administered to said patient in an amount effective to accelerate lipolysis; or

wherein said third ethyl acetate extract or said fourth methanol extract is administered to said patient ~~is administered~~ in an amount effective to inhibit adipogenesis.

10) (Canceled)

11) (Currently amended) The method of claim 44, comprising:

administering ~~an~~ said effective amount of ~~an~~ said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* fruit to said patient, wherein said administration of the organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* fruit inhibits lipid accumulation or stimulates lipolysis in said patient.

12) (Currently amended) The method of claim 44, comprising:

administering ~~an~~ said effective amount of ~~an~~ said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* to said patient;

wherein said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* is a non-alcoholic extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or an extract of *Ficus hispida* fruit, wherein said administration of the organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* ~~fruit~~ inhibits lipid accumulation or stimulates lipolysis in said patient.

13) (Previously presented) The method of claim 12, wherein said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* is an ethyl acetate extract of *Ficus hispida* fruit, a methanol extract of *Ficus hispida* fruit, a hydroalcoholic extract of *Ficus hispida* fruit, an ethyl acetate extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves, or a mixture thereof.

14) (Previously presented) The method of claim 44, wherein said at least one symptom is atherosclerosis.

15) (Previously presented) The method of claim 44, wherein said at least one symptom is diabetes.

16-20)(Canceled)

21) (Currently amended) The method of claim 44, comprising:
administering ~~an~~ said effective amount of ~~an~~ said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* to said patient;

wherein said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* is a non-alcoholic extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or an extract of *Ficus hispida* fruit, wherein said administration of the organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or fruit stimulates adiponectin production in said patient.

22-40)(Canceled)

41) (Currently amended) The method of claim 44, comprising:
administering ~~an~~ said effective amount of ~~an~~ said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* to said patient;

wherein said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* is a non-alcoholic extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or an extract of *Ficus hispida* fruit, wherein said administration of the organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or fruit ameliorates an inflammatory biomarker protein or molecule in said patient, and _____ wherein said inflammatory biomarker protein or molecule is selected from the group consisting of $\text{TNF}\alpha$, IL-1 β , IL-6, MMP-3 and NF κ B, whose expression is altered during inflammatory conditions.

42-43)(Canceled)

44) (Previously presented) A method of treating a metabolic disorder in a patient in need thereof comprising:

a) obtaining an organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or *Ficus hispida* fruit; and

b) administering an effective amount of said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or *Ficus hispida* fruit to said patient;

wherein the metabolic disorder is selected from the group consisting of: obesity, low HDL cholesterol, high triglycerides, diabetes, impaired fasting glucose, dyslipidemia, high total cholesterol, atherosclerosis and hyperglycemia.

45) (Previously presented) The method of claim 44, wherein said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or *Ficus hispida* fruit is obtained by extraction of *Ficus hispida* leaves or *Ficus hispida* fruit with an organic solvent selected from the group consisting of: hexane, dichloromethane, chloroform, ethyl acetate, acetone, methanol, ethanol, n-butanol, isopropanol, methyl isobutyl ketone, aqueous methanol or a mixture thereof.

46) (Currently amended) A method of treating a metabolic disorder in a patient in need thereof comprising:

administering an effective amount of said an organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or *Ficus hispida* fruit to said patient,

_____wherein the metabolic disorder is selected from the group consisting of: obesity, low HDL cholesterol, high triglycerides, diabetes, impaired fasting glucose, dyslipidemia, high total cholesterol, atherosclerosis and hyperglycemia, and

_____wherein said organic solvent extract is selected from the group consisting of: an ethyl acetate extract of *Ficus hispida* or leaves, a methanol extract of *Ficus hispida* fruit or leaves, a hydroalcoholic extract of *Ficus hispida* fruit or leaves or a mixture thereof.

47) (Previously presented) The method of claim 1, wherein said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or *Ficus hispida* fruit is orally, topically or parenterally administered or administered by inhalation.

48) (Previously presented) The method of claim 1, wherein said organic solvent extract of *Ficus hispida* leaves or *Ficus hispida* fruit is administered at least once daily.